ILLUMINATE

ENTREPRENEURS: Ethan Kelty, 4/14/26

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Illuminate is a eco friendly ed printed lamp making business. We are focused on making bright, affordable, and good-looking lamps. We are selling them for between $17-$22 based on type and light source. We have many options of lamps to reach as many people as possible and bring light into their dark corners.

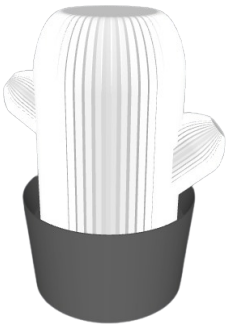
BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

Mission Statement
To bring thoughtfully-designed, minimal, eco-friendly lighting into the dark, neglected corners of our customers' workspaces and homes

Business Opportunity
Our customers have neglected dim parts of their home or workspace and need a solution. They want to use this space, but can't find a way to make it work. Our customers like minimal, eco-friendly products and have a lot of style. They spend a lot of time in one area and want to freshen it up with something that won't just take up space. We provide a cost-effective, simple, and minimal solution to this issue. Our lamps are bright, simple, and versatile. Our products can blend in or stand out, serving as a supporting piece or a showcase element in any room or space. We will offer many options for people to find the design that works for their space.

Detailed Product Description
Our products are light, simple, and elegant. We have 3 models, all of which offer something special to the user.

1. Minimal Grey/White
    a. This lamp is smooth and bright; it blends into the background and provides bright, consistent light to illuminate any space.



2. Cactus Grey/White
    a. This is a simple yet effective fuzzy cactus-like lamp. Featuring a white cactus-shaped shade and a grey minimal plant pot base

3. Geometric Grey/White
    a. This is a simple geometric lamp. The interconnected triangles make a mesmerising yet calm essence.

Competition and Differentiation

Illuminate's main competitors are (1) big-box retailers like Target/Walmart/IKEA, (2) Etsy/online handmade lamp sellers. Big-box stores are strong because they are cheap, trusted, and easy to buy from, but their lamps are usually generic and not customizable. Etsy sellers are strong because they offer unique handmade designs and personalization. Still, they are often more expensive, take longer to arrive, and customers can't see the lamp in person before buying. Illuminate's differentiation is its modern minimalist design with cozy lighting that customers can see working immediately at the booth, plus a strong "local, student-made" story and simple customization options that add uniqueness without slowing sales.

Materials and Labor Sourcing and Distribution

We will source materials through online suppliers to keep costs low. Filament (PLA) will be purchased in bulk from Amazon, along with electrical components like E27 socket/cord kits, inline switches, bulbs, and rechargeable USB-C puck lights. Labor will be done in-house by Ethan, who designs, prints, assembles, and quality-tests each lamp; this keeps quality control high and costs low. The supply chain is: order parts and filament → 3D print lamp bases/shades on two printers → assemble wiring or install puck lights → test each lamp for function and appearance → package in branded bags with stickers → stage inventory for sales.

For distribution, Illuminate will sell directly at the GHS Trade Show (May 19, 2026) using a booth display with powered lamp demos and fast pricing signage, accepting payments through Square. If the business grows, Illuminate can expand distribution by taking orders through an online form and a simple online store (Shopify/Etsy), shipping via USPS, and eventually partnering with local gift shops or boutiques for consignment or wholesale to reach customers beyond the trade show audience.

Location and Facilities

In the start-up stage, Illuminate will run from my home workspace, which will act as the office (planning, ordering, customer messages), manufacturing space (3D printing + assembly/testing), and storage (parts, filament, finished lamps on shelves). The main retail location at launch will be the GHS Trade Show booth on May 19, 2026, where there is strong foot traffic and power for live lamp demos. In the small business stage, Illuminate would still operate primarily from home but add more retail channels like local markets and online sales (Instagram + a simple shop), shipping from Portland via USPS. In the mid-to-large stage, the business would move into a small light-industrial studio/workshop in the Portland metro area to fit more printers, an assembly/packaging area, and organized inventory storage, while expanding sales through wholesale to local boutiques and more frequent events.

MARKET ANALYSIS

Market Characteristics and Target Customer

The trade show market for Illuminate is the GHS Trade Show audience of about 2,000 attendees, including roughly 600 high school students (30%) and about 1,400 adults/community members. Realistically, only a fraction will stop and seriously consider buying, but even 10–20% engagement would mean ~200–400 potential buyers in one day. The U.S. industry Illuminate fits into (home lighting/lamps and home décor) is

very large (multi-billion-dollar), and within it, Illuminate targets the niche of design-focused, customizable, small-batch lighting sold through events and direct-to-consumer channels. Key trends supporting Illuminate include minimalist/modern décor, cozy, warm ambient lighting, custom/personalized products, and growing interest in rechargeable/portable USB-C lighting and local handmade goods. For the first 3 months, Illuminate will target Portland-area students (15–18) and their families (because they're the core trade show audience and like unique items), plus local young adults (19–35) who decorate bedrooms/dorms/apartments and value aesthetic, functional décor; a realistic reachable local market over that period is roughly ~1,500–3,000 people, with the trade show being the biggest concentration of buyers.

Market Research

- survey size: newer version had 38 responses (mostly students)
- demand signal: 15 said yes and 13 said maybe to buying at a school trade show (about 90% yes/maybe)
- uniqueness: about 81% said they like unique/custom items (supports customization as an upsell)
- style preferences: top liked styles were minimalist, geometric/modern, then nature-themed (moon/mountains/trees)
- pricing insight: most common willingness-to-pay ranges were 10–15 and 15–20, with some willing to pay 20–30
- what people care about: cozy/warm light, some want bright light, simple controls/switch, customization, stable base
- how this changed the plan: focus on minimalist designs, demo warm vs bright at the booth, keep a simple price list.

MARKETING AND SALES

The Brand

Illuminate's brand assets are meant to feel clean, modern, and uncluttered, just like the lamps. The name Illuminate tells the story of bringing light into dark, unused corners of a room and making a space feel calmer and more functional. The logo is kept simple (a clean wordmark) so it looks premium, is easy to recognize, and doesn't distract from the product design. Our colors are white, black, and yellow because they match a minimalist feel, make the brand feel timeless, and keep the focus on the glow of the lamp rather than busy graphics.

Name: Illuminate
Slogan: Brighten your day
Colors: Black, White, Yellow
Fonts: Simple modern sans-serif (clean and easy to read, not decorative)

Logo Image

ILLUMINATE

Slogan Image

BRIGHTEN
YOUR DAY

Color Palette Image (hex codes)

FFC800	FFFFFF	000000

Business Font image

League Gothic

Glacial Indifference

Retail Location

Describe how you will engage your customers at the Trade Show with your display. Include a picture of your display plan.

Founder's Story

On a warm Sunday late in 2025, my father and I were looking for things to do. While browsing a local newspaper, I found an idea. There was an art tradeshow happening at a local art center. We got in the car and drove over to a large, busy warehouse covered in murals and other artworks. We parked and walked in, following the push of the crowd, and we rounded a corner where I found a booth with a 3D printer. Immediately intrigued, I walked over and took a look at what they were selling. A collection of lamps, vases, and other 3d printed toys was laid out on the table before me. Immediately, I wanted one; they were simple, bright, and beautiful. However, seeing the price tag made me flinch. $50 fo this plastic piece was far too much money for me to spend on something I could make myself for much less. Then it hit me, this would be a great tradeshow idea! Make a collection of 3d printed lamps at a more affordable price.

Promotion
I will send out a flyer via email to everyone I know in Portland to invite them to come with a discount code for my booth. I will ask my parents to do the same to reach as many people as possible. I will have coupons for people we know, and during the last 30 minutes of the show, if we have stock, we will reduce the price to try to sell out. I will ask people I know to give a review on the product and tell me their thoughts on the lamps. I will not do any paid advertising because it is expensive and I don't have the budget for it. In addition, I don't think that they will give me enough to make money from the ad

PERSONNEL AND MANAGEMENT

PERSONNEL
As the founder of Illuminate, Ethan brings proven leadership and real business experience, not just an idea. He is the owner of a graphic design company, where he has built skills in branding, visual communication, and creating products that look professional and appealing to customers. He is also the owner of a CO2 monitoring organization, which has strengthened his ability to manage operations, stay organized, track details, and work responsibly with real-world expectations. Across these companies, Ethan has developed strong project management habits—planning, budgeting, meeting deadlines, and delivering consistent quality—which directly support Illuminate's success because the business depends on reliable production, clear pricing, and a polished customer experience at the trade show. He is hands-on and accountable: he designs the products, manages sourcing, oversees production and quality control, and handles marketing and sales. These experiences show investors that Illuminate is led by someone who can execute, adapt quickly, and run a small business professionally from day one.

Rebekah Sobel, Financial Advisor.
She was the CFO of a national Jewish museum organization, the director of the Oregon Jewish Museum, worked at the national archives as a policy coordinator, and has lots of money.
Joel Kelty Destion Reviewer
As the ANC (area neighbourhood commissioner) and a long-time human with fully developed decision-making skills, he will be crucial in avoiding unnecessary mistakes and issues.

OWNERSHIP

LEGAL FORMS OF OWNERSHIP
Sole proprietorship

It's easy to start, and while the liability is personal, I don't have to pay for a licence for the tradeshow. In addition, filing costs money, and I don't want to pay for that.
Ownership: Ethan Kelty 100%
Liability: Ethan Kelty
Funding: Ethan Kelty, Rebekah Sobel
Taxes: Ethan Kelty

FINANCIALS

START-UP COSTS AND FUNDING STRATEGY

Based on my current production plan of 36 lamps (12 puck-light models and 24 bulb models) and my budget, the anticipated start-up cost to launch Illuminate is about 281.33. This total includes approximately 225.16 for product materials (filament and lighting components) and about 56.17 for packaging and trade show display supplies (bags, tissue, stamp, poster board, and sign lighting), not counting equipment I already own, like 3D printers or other free/owned items. For funding, I will use a bootstrapping strategy for the initial launch as a sole proprietor by combining personal funds with family/in-kind support already reflected in the budget, which allows me to start quickly without taking on debt or giving up control. For growth after the trade show, I will reinvest profits and use pre-orders for customized lamps so customers pay before I produce larger batches, reducing inventory risk and improving cash flow; if demand becomes consistent and I need to scale faster, I may later use a small microloan or carefully managed business credit to purchase equipment or inventory in bulk.

FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS: PROJECTED COSTS, PROJECTED REVENUE, PROJECTED PRICING, GROSS MARGIN BASED ON RETAIL, BREAK-EVEN POINT

My financial projection is based on selling 36 lamps at the trade show (12 puck models and 24 bulb models) at two main retail prices: $18 (standard) and $22 (bulb). Estimated COGS is $4.55 for the $18 lamps and $6.35 for the $22 lamps, which gives gross margins of about 74.7% ($13.45 profit on $18) and 71.1% ($15.65 profit on $22). The budget projects about $814 in total revenue and about $578.85 net profit after card fees (2.6% + $0.15). Fixed launch expenses are about $56.17 for packaging/display supplies, and the total start-up cost is about $281.33. Using break-even analysis, Illuminate breaks even at about $281 in sales, which is roughly 13 lamps (about $281 ÷ ~$22 average price), so the pricing strategy is set to cover costs quickly and still feel affordable at the trade show.

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